JESUS MEDINA

SUMMARY

Software and DevOps engineer who leads products from architecture to production. Founded and built Mesa, a payments platform, end to end; ran Kubernetes infrastructure for Federal Student Aid systems serving millions; led migrations and releases across engineering, QA and product teams.

EXPERIENCE

Founder & Lead Engineer
Mesa Treasury LLC | Chicago, Illinois | February 2025 - Current

- Founded and built community-governed POS and marketplace platform (Django, React Native), enabling user ownership and participation.
- Developed governance features including proposals, voting, and public treasury ledger, enhancing transparency and community engagement.
- Designed Stripe Connect payments with automatic fee routing to a community treasury.
- Built real-time, end-to-end encrypted chat with WebSockets and Redis.
- Modeled unit economics and set pricing at 4% + 30¢.
- Managed production environment on Heroku; took the app through App Store review with 15–20 shops lined up.

Content Manager
Jellyvision | Chicago, Illinois | July 2024 - October 2024

- Published 50+ Data Releases (DRs) for ALEX with 95%+ on-time rollouts.
- Collaborated with Engineering, QA, and Product to improve DR reliability.
- Executed Jenkins smoke tests, achieving ~20% reduction in release issues.

Sr DevOps Engineer
Smoothstack | Fairfax, VA | March 2023 - January 2024

- Led ROSA migration strategy for OpenShift clusters, enhancing scalability and security while streamlining operations
- Operated production/staging Kubernetes clusters for Federal Student Aid systems, ensuring reliable service for millions of users
- Monitored cluster health and system performance using Prometheus and Grafana across federal environments

Devops Engineer
Smoothstack | Chicago, Illinois | July 2021 - March 2023

- Contributed to U.S. Department of Education / FAFSA platform work through Accenture Federal Services over 2+ years, enhancing system reliability and compliance
- Built Jenkins CI pipelines and deployed Dockerized microservices to AWS/Kubernetes environments
- Deployed containerized services to AWS/Kubernetes environments, streamlining development and deployment processes using Docker and DevOps workflows
- Facilitated secure release processes and infrastructure automation while implementing DevSecOps practices for systems managing sensitive student data

CONTACT

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SKILLS

- Python/Django development
- JavaScript/React/React Native
- AWS
- Docker
- Kubernetes administration
- DevOps automation
- CI CD pipelines
- Cloud migration
- Production monitoring
- Real-time systems
- Release management
- Strategic planning
- Product ownership
- Linux

EDUCATION

Coding Bootcamp
Chi Codes

- Graduated valedictorian.
- Learned full-stack Python web development.
- Educational training was provided by the Coding Dojo.
- Program was sponsored by Facebook, Microsoft, and the Rockefeller Foundation.

November 2019

Jr DevOps Engineer
Dom and Tom | Chicago, Illinois | June 2018 - January 2019

- Containerized applications for startups and Fortune 500 companies, including Tyson Foods and Pfizer Inc., using Docker.
- Provisioned and deployed containers with Rancher Orchestration, leveraging Kubernetes technology.
- Executed 20+ application and database migrations to AWS for Tyson Foods Inc.
- Dom and Tom is a product agency that helps Fortune 500 companies and next generation startups build the future of digital.

PROJECTS

- Mesa — Community Payments & Marketplace Platform | mesatreasury.com
  February 2025 – Present
  - Built a POS and marketplace app for local businesses with Django, React Native and Stripe Connect.
  - Routes a small fee on every payment into a community-governed neighborhood treasury.
  - Includes bookings, ordering, encrypted chat and civic data maps; bilingual (EN/ES).
  - Submitted to the App Store; 15–20 local shops lined up for launch.
- Eden — AI Research Simulation | https://eden-bgcy.onrender.com/
  August 2026 – Present
  - Built a 3D world (Three.js) where AI creatures learn to survive, evolve and raise offspring.
  - Wrote the neural networks from scratch (forward pass and backpropagation, no ML framework).
  - Pairs each network with an LLM planner, the same plan-and-act split used in AI agents.
  - Spoken words reach the creatures as input signals, not commands; obedience has to be learned.
  - Every weight is shown live, so you can trace a behavior back to the numbers that caused it.
  - Explores whether a creator can communicate with AI beings through prompting.

  Tech (Eden): JavaScript, Three.js, Python, SQLite, LLM APIs (Gemini/OpenAI), Web Speech, Heroku